

MMSU's Commitment

Take an active role in protecting and promoting sustainable use of terrestrial ecosystems, responsible land use, and biodiversity conservation.

SDG 15.2.6 · Sustainable management of land for tourism (educational outreach)

Offer educational programme/outreach for local or national communities on sustainable management of land for tourism.

Evidence year: 2025 (calendar year), with continuing implementation 2024–2026

DRAFT. No 2025 community training on sustainable land management for tourism was found. The newest item is the January 2026 approval and site visit for the TALON farm tourism project, which is a project plan, not yet an outreach programme. Add its educational activities (dates, audience, free access) once they run, or submit it as the approved project plan.

No 2025 item was found for this indicator. The material below is from before 2025 or from 2026 and, as far as the records show, is still in place.

Continuing implementation

Policies and programmes that began before 2025 and continue to be implemented, with 2024 and 2026 activities that show the programme is ongoing. THE accepts policies that are already in place.

DOST-PCAARRD and UP-ISSI Assess MMSU's Proposed TALON Farm Tourism Project

Continuing implementation · site visit of January 15, 2026



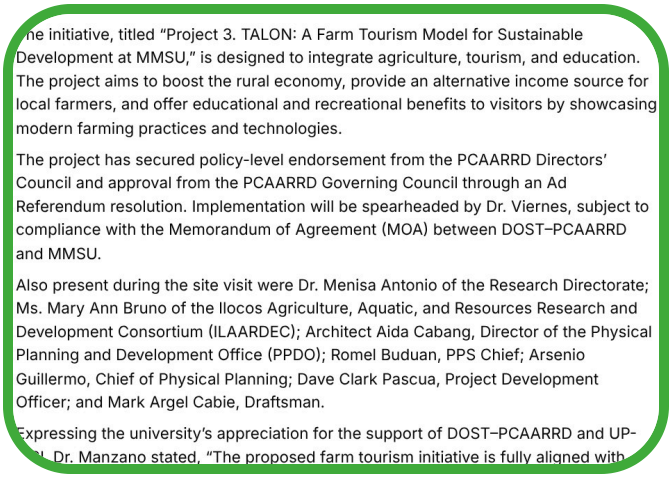
DOST-PCAARRD, UP-ISSI visit proposed MMSU farm tourism project site

By Wimbledon Bosque

Officials from the Department of Science and Technology–Philippine Council for Agriculture, Aquatic and Natural Resources Research and Development (DOST–PCAARRD) and the University of the Philippines–Institute for Small-Scale Industries (UP-ISSI) conducted a site visit at the Mariano Marcos State University (MMSU) Crops Research Laboratory on January 15 to assess the proposed farm tourism project under the Science for the Convergence of Agriculture and Tourism (SciCAT) Expansion Program.

The delegation, led by Assistant Professor Melanie Moraga-Leaño, Director of UP-ISSI and SciCAT Program Leader, together with UP-ISSI extension specialists Kaye Bravo-Coballes, Janelle Faye Tanudtanud, Joshua Garcia, and Garry Nipales, along with Dianne Cabello of the Technology Transfer and Promotion Division, DOST–PCAARRD, [illegible] welcomed by MMSU President Virgilio Julius Manzano, Jr.

Capture: MMSU News, 20 January 2026, "DOST-PCAARRD, UP-ISSI visit proposed MMSU farm tourism project site" (headline and opening paragraphs).



[illegible]he initiative, titled "Project 3. TALON: A Farm Tourism Model for Sustainable Development at MMSU," is designed to integrate agriculture, tourism, and education. The project aims to boost the rural economy, provide an alternative income source for local farmers, and offer educational and recreational benefits to visitors by showcasing modern farming practices and technologies.

The project has secured policy-level endorsement from the PCAARRD Directors' Council and approval from the PCAARRD Governing Council through an Ad Referendum resolution. Implementation will be spearheaded by Dr. Viernes, subject to compliance with the Memorandum of Agreement (MOA) between DOST–PCAARRD and MMSU.

Also present during the site visit were Dr. Menisa Antonio of the Research Directorate; Ms. Mary Ann Bruno of the Ilocos Agriculture, Aquatic, and Resources Research and Development Consortium (ILAARDEC); Architect Aida Cabang, Director of the Physical Planning and Development Office (PPDO); Romel Buduan, PPS Chief; Arsenio Guillermo, Chief of Physical Planning; Dave Clark Pascua, Project Development Officer; and Mark Argel Cabie, Draftsman.

Expressing the university's appreciation for the support of DOST–PCAARRD and UP-[illegible], Dr. Manzano stated, "The proposed farm tourism initiative is fully aligned with

Capture: the same article, on Project 3 TALON and the approval of the PCAARRD Governing Council.

On January 15, 2026, officials of the Department of Science and Technology–Philippine Council for Agriculture, Aquatic and Natural Resources Research and Development (DOST-PCAARRD) and the University of the Philippines–Institute for Small-Scale Industries (UP-ISSI) visited the MMSU Crops Research Laboratory to assess a proposed farm tourism project under the Science for the Convergence of Agriculture and Tourism (SciCAT) Expansion Program. The delegation, led by UP-ISSI Director and SciCAT Program Leader Asst. Prof. Melanie Moraga-Leaño, was welcomed by MMSU President Virgilio Julius P. Manzano Jr. and guided through an on-site technical walkthrough by MMSU's Vice President for Research, Development and Innovation, the Director for Research, Innovation and Technology, the dean of the College of Business, Economics and Accountancy, and project members from its Department of Tourism and Hospitality Management led by Dr. Eva Jean Viernes. Planners of the Physical Planning and Development Office and the Ilocos Agriculture, Aquatic and Natural Resources Research and Development Consortium (ILAARRDEC) also took part.

The project, "Project 3. TALON: A Farm Tourism Model for Sustainable Development at MMSU," is designed to integrate agriculture, tourism and education. It aims to boost the rural economy, provide an alternative income source for local farmers, and offer educational and recreational benefits to visitors by showcasing modern farming practices and technologies. The project has the endorsement of the PCAARRD Directors' Council and the approval of the PCAARRD Governing Council through an Ad Referendum resolution, and its implementation, led by Dr. Viernes, is subject to the memorandum of agreement between DOST-PCAARRD and MMSU. MMSU is among

the select institutions developing science-and-technology-based agri-tourism hubs under SciCAT, which turns farms into tourism sites to promote innovation, entrepreneurship and community development.

Source

- MMSU News, “DOST-PCAARRD, UP-ISSI visit proposed MMSU farm tourism project site,” 20 January 2026
  https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/article/news/2869/dost-pcaarrd-up-issi-visit-proposed-mmsu-farm-tourism-project-site

Biodiversity Conservation Learning Center and Leisure Park Is Enriched with 28 Native Tree Species

Continuing implementation · since 2023

On January 13, 2023, MMSU planted 120 more seedlings of 28 native tree species and two bamboo species at the Biodiversity Conservation Learning Center and Leisure Park on the Main Campus, led by then President Shirley C. Agrupis with administrators, faculty, staff and students. The park is used as a field laboratory for classes and was identified for development into a health and wellness tourism hub, a plan endorsed by the provincial government and aligned with the Health and Wellness Complex of the College of Medicine.

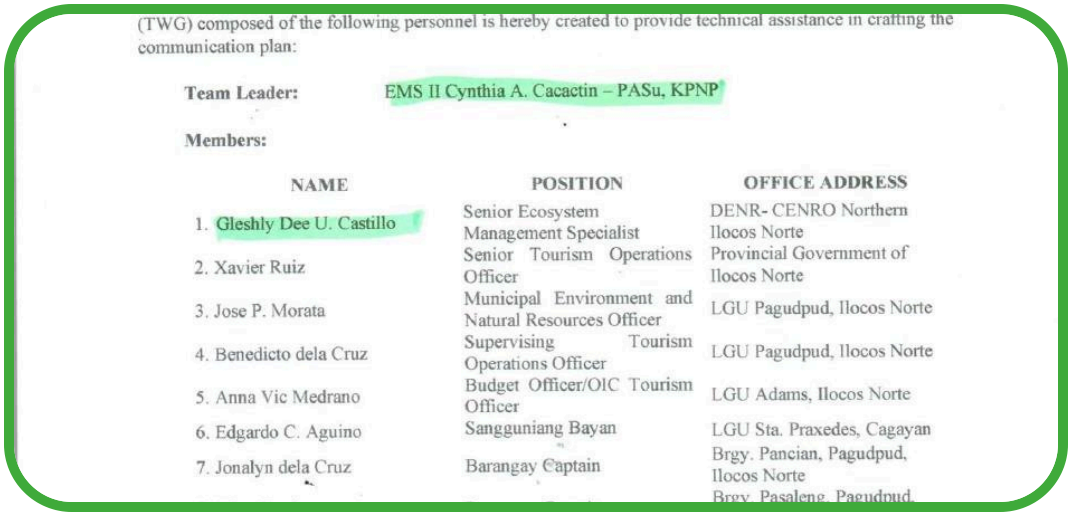
The planting continues a tradition that began in 2017 with the Green Wall project on the Batac campus and extends to the Nagbacsan site and the Currimao, Dingras and Laoag campuses, as the university’s contribution to the provincial “Green Wall of Ilocos Norte” and the National Greening Program of the Department of Environment and Natural Resources.

Source

- MMSU News, “More trees planted at MMSU to establish ‘health tourism’ hub,” 13 January 2023
  https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/news/more-trees-planted-at-mmsu-to-establish-health-tourism-hub

MMSU Expert Serves on the Kalbario-Patapat Natural Park Technical Working Group

Continuing role · appointment of 29 March 2023



(TWG) composed of the following personnel is hereby created to provide technical assistance in crafting the communication plan:

Team Leader: EMS II Cynthia A. Cacactin – PASu, KPNP

Members:

NAME	POSITION	OFFICE ADDRESS
1. Gleshly Dee U. Castillo	Senior Ecosystem Management Specialist	DENR- CENRO Northern Ilocos Norte
2. Xavier Ruiz	Senior Tourism Operations Officer	Provincial Government of Ilocos Norte
3. Jose P. Morata	Municipal Environment and Natural Resources Officer	LGU Pagudpud, Ilocos Norte
4. Benedicto dela Cruz	Supervising Tourism Operations Officer	LGU Pagudpud, Ilocos Norte
5. Anna Vic Medrano	Budget Officer/OIC Tourism Officer	LGU Adams, Ilocos Norte
6. Edgardo C. Aguino	Sangguniang Bayan	LGU Sta. Praxedes, Cagayan
7. Jonalyn dela Cruz	Barangay Captain	Brgy. Pancian, Pagudpud, Ilocos Norte
		Brgy. Pasaleng, Pagudpud,

Document: DENR-PENRO Ilocos Norte Special Order No. 2023-024 (29 March 2023) naming Dr. Arlene L. Gonzales of MMSU to the KPNP Technical Working Group.

Through DENR-PENRO Ilocos Norte Special Order No. 2023-024, dated March 29, 2023, Dr. Arlene L. Gonzales of MMSU was named a member of the Technical Working Group that prepares the Communication Plan of the Kalbario-Patapat Natural Park (KPNP), a protected area in Ilocos Norte. The group, led by the KPNP Protected Area Superintendent, brings together DENR offices, the Provincial Government of Ilocos Norte, the LGUs of Pagudpud and Adams in Ilocos Norte and Sta. Praxedes in Cagayan, barangay officials and Northwestern University.

The Communication Plan supports the goal of the KPNP Protected Area Management Plan to adopt and carry out effective information and education campaigns for biological diversity conservation and for the promotion of the protected area as a major ecotourism destination.

Source

- DENR-PENRO Ilocos Norte Special Order No. 2023-024, 29 March 2023 (MMSU SDG 15 page) https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/resources/1TCpM-DxbkgfOh4QGwlfVr8QavCchKWKu/data